

The traditional PC will transform itself into an AI PC

In conversation with **Jun Ouyang**, Vice President and General Manager, Consumer Business for PCs and Smart Devices at Lenovo

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Jun Ouyang, Lenovo's Vice President and General Manager of Consumer Business for PCs and Smart Devices, discusses the company's outlook for 2024 and the pivotal role of AI in shaping the future of personal computing. From gaming advancements to Lenovo's strategies for captivating gamers with its product lineup, Jun Ouyang provides insights into what lies ahead for Lenovo in 2024 and beyond.

🗣️ At CES 2024, I got my hands on the latest portfolio of Lenovo's line-up. The highlights for me were the hybrid range, particularly the ThinkBook Plus and the Yoga Book 9i. The Yoga and ThinkBook range seem to be expanding from being a pure business/thin-n-light to evolving into performance-centric laptops with larger displays, powerful processors, and creator-centric features. Can you talk about how you see these appealing to the target markets?

👤 I personally handle Lenovo's Consumer business segment which includes Lenovo Yoga, Lenovo IdeaPad, Lenovo Legion, and Lenovo LOQ—I'm extremely proud of my team's collective effort in creating the Yoga Book 9i and bringing it to market. It's devices like the Yoga Book 9i which truly embody Lenovo's commitment to innovation. The Yoga Book 9i is the end result of our goal to make a



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device that transcends traditional form factors, allowing users to create, edit, and present their creations on a modular, free-form device.

The initial idea for the concept that became the Yoga Book 9i came about in 2018 when we took a look at the creator device landscape and identified that while creative devices were often powerful, they generally followed traditional laptop/AIO/tower form factors. We wanted to create a device for creators that could act not only as a traditional laptop, but also a large-format tablet, painter's palette, sketchpad, and easel. With the Yoga Book 9i, creative pursuits are

not stymied by a given form-factor. We believe that creativity is born of artistic freedom, and the Yoga Book 9i delivers on that in spades.

While I can't speak to the particulars of the ThinkBook Plus Gen 5 (Hybrid) as it's not under my purview, the device is a remarkable device that offers multiple mode scenarios that deliver the best of laptop and tablet computing devices. Giving users the option to switch seamlessly between Windows and Android so they can work on both individually and even "stream" Android into Windows via Picture-in-Picture technology, along with the dedicated NPU from the Intel Core Ultra chip that powers AI solutions, are truly innovative steps in workflow optimization.

🗣️ Lenovo has its own AI chip and it seems to be finding a place inside more and more Lenovo laptops, not just gaming but also the Yoga series as well. The same laptops are also powered by Intel's Core Ultra processors which have their own dedicated AI-powered NPU cores. How will the two AI computing engines work together?

👤 In the creator space, the AI Core present on some of our Lenovo Yoga communicates with the Intel chip, providing it with more detailed information and logic instruction based on the current user scenario, which the Intel SoC—be it the CPU, NPU, etc.—then executes on. The relationship between the Lenovo AI Core and Intel Core Ultra processors is more of a hand-off than an overlap.

Lenovo gaming devices equipped with Intel processors all use Intel HX processors which are more geared toward performance and do not have dedicated NPU cores, as gamers tend to preference raw power over efficiency. AI algorithm functions are accomplished by leveraging the high TGP of Lenovo gaming PC GPUs, and our Lenovo LA AI Core is there to help tune power delivery at a system level to make sure power is being routed where it needs to be depending on the task.

Lenovo Yoga devices that feature both Intel Core Ultra processors and Lenovo